



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

CHILDREN JOIN a conversation about love of their families and fears about ICE being in their community.

In response to L.A. raids, parents prepare for the worst

Sonia's son has been anxious lately, crying and asking why their neighbor had been picking him up from preschool instead of his mom. She doesn't know what to tell him. At just 4 years old, he's too young to understand the truth.

Sonia has lived in the U.S. without legal status for 25 years, harvesting squash, cilantro and tomatoes in the fields of Riverside County. But she can no longer risk leaving her house to pick up her child for fear of being detained or deported by federal agents.

She has begun preparing for something far worse than a missed pickup — the possibility that their separation could become permanent.

Last week, Sonia visited the of-

Fearing deportation, families make plans for emergency care and ponder the unthinkable: Giving up their children

BY JENNY GOLD

fices of TODEC, a legal center in the Inland Empire serving immigrants and farmworkers, to fill out the forms that will allow her sister to take over the care of her three American citizen children — ages 4, 7, and 10 — in the event that she and her husband are deported. “I already want to cry,” said Sonia, who requested that her full name not be used to protect her.

Since June 6 — when the Department of Homeland Security began widespread raids throughout the Los Angeles region — the number of immigrant parents making emergency arrangements for their children's care has skyrocketed. Parents have flooded legal rights organizations in person [See **Parents**, A8]

State hit hard by weather service cuts

Staff shortages in California forecasting offices raise worries as fire season intensifies.

BY RONG-GONG LIN II

Some National Weather Service offices in California are among those hit hardest by meteorologist vacancies, according to new data from an employee union — heightening concerns as the state contends with another potentially devastating fire season and the ongoing threat of extreme weather.

The staffing shortages have forced some offices to outsource overnight operations to neighboring offices or reduce how often they issue forecast products that help keep decision-makers and first responders abreast of potentially hazardous

weather conditions.

Trump administration officials have rejected the idea that recent cuts have imperiled the weather service's operations — even as those decisions have come under increased scrutiny after disastrous flooding in Texas that left at least 132 people dead. With fire season intensifying, California will be a key test case to determine the impact of the cuts.

Two of the nation's weather forecast offices with the worst meteorologist vacancy rates are in California. They are the Hanford office, which covers the San Joaquin Valley, including Fresno and Bakersfield; and the Sacramento office, which also covers Stockton, Modesto, Vallejo, Chico and Redding.

The offices are also responsible for the western Si-

[See **Weather**, A5]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

ADVOCATES warn weather service cuts will make it harder to prepare for disasters such as the Eaton fire.

Inflation fueled by tariffs starts to emerge

Consumer prices rose 2.7% in June from year earlier — the highest rate in four months.

BY CHRISTOPHER RUGABER AND JOSH BOAK

Inflation rose last month to its highest level since February as President Trump's sweeping tariffs push up the cost of a variety of goods, including furniture, clothing and large appliances.

Consumer prices rose 2.7% in June from a year earlier, the Labor Department said Tuesday, up from an annual increase of 2.4% in May. On a monthly basis, prices climbed 0.3% from May to June, after rising just 0.1% the previous month.

Worsening inflation poses a political challenge for Trump, who promised during last year's presidential campaign to immediately lower costs only to engage in a whipsawed frenzy of tariffs that have left businesses and consumers worried. Trump has declared that the U.S. in effect has no more inflation as he has attempted to pressure Federal Reserve Chair Jerome H. Powell into cutting short-term interest rates.

Yet the bump in inflation last month makes it more likely that the central bank will keep rates unchanged at its next meeting in two weeks. Powell has said he wants to see how the economy reacts to Trump's duties before reducing borrowing costs.

Excluding the volatile food and energy categories, core inflation increased 2.9% in June from a year earlier, up from 2.8% in May. On a monthly basis, it picked up 0.2% from May to June. Economists closely watch core prices because they typically provide a better [See **Inflation**, A10]

Wildfire defense sprinklers: Boon or bane?

One man says the device saved a Palisades home. Experts fear it could discourage evacuations.

BY NOAH HAGGERTY



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

PATRICK Golling is convinced the system he helped create saved his father's home from the Palisades fire.

cobbled-together version of the tech that he says saved his father's home from the Palisades fire, Robinson cold-called him, and Realize Safety was born.

Now, the two talk of ambitious visions where entire neighborhoods living amid California's rugged brush-covered landscapes band together to create a community defense network of automated firefighters.

Their system is the latest entrant in a growing group of often-expensive, high-tech sprinkler systems designed to protect homes in high fire hazard areas. But while a blue-ribbon commission after the January fires recommended L.A. adopt exterior sprinkler technology, some fire officials warn there's limited evidence that these elaborate [See **Wildfires**, A7]

Half of National Guard in L.A. being sent home

BY GRACE TOOHEY

Nearly six weeks into a controversial military deployment, the Pentagon on Tuesday announced that half of the almost 4,000 National Guard soldiers who had been deployed to the Los Angeles area would be released from duty.

The move comes after a prolonged legal battle over whether the Trump administration had the right to deploy the troops and scathing criticism from state and local leaders that the military was not needed to deal with protests over immigration raids that have led to around 3,000 arrests.

President Trump justified the troops as necessary, citing scattered unrest during the first few days of the immigration sweeps. But the protests calmed relatively quickly and were primarily kept in check by local police. The National Guard ended up largely protecting federal buildings.

Pentagon spokesperson Sean Parnell said Tuesday that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had ordered 2,000 of the National Guard troops released from what officials called a “federal protection mission.”

“Thanks to our troops who stepped up to answer the call, the lawlessness in Los Angeles is subsiding,” Parnell said in a statement.

Hegseth and the Trump administration had federalized more than 4,000 California National Guard soldiers in an unprecedented display of force, which local leaders repeatedly said only inflamed the situation.

Even with the 2,000 troops headed home, that still leaves another 2,000 in the Guard and 700 Marines activated in the area.

After learning of the troop reduction Tuesday, Gov. Gavin Newsom called [See **Guard**, A5]

Nextdoor doesn't want to be the 'boring' app

Platform that shined in pandemic has since dimmed. Co-founder aims to change that.

BY QUEENIE WONG

Nextdoor, the once-hot social network for neighborhoods, wants to claw its way back to the top and prove that people can use the platform for more than just finding lost cats.

The San Francisco company's shares have plunged more than 80% since its market debut in 2021. Nextdoor shined brightly when people locked at home during the COVID-19 pandemic spent more time online, but in recent years, the platform has lost its luster.

For Nextdoor co-founder Nirav Tolia, who returned last year as the chief executive, the company's turnaround plan comes with high stakes and a ton of emotion.

Tolia, a charismatic serial entrepreneur who uses a

lot of metaphors, described Nextdoor as one of his own children.

He stepped down as Nextdoor's chief executive in 2018 but remained on the board before retaking the helm more than five years later.

“You don't really get too many chances in life to truly have a second whack at things,” said Tolia, a 53-year-old father of three.

Nextdoor, a place where neighbors post about missing pets, stolen packages and furniture sales, hasn't changed drastically over the years. And that's part of the problem, analysts say.

Other social networks such as Instagram, YouTube and TikTok have held people's attention and gobbed up ad dollars through short-form videos. Meanwhile, people are increasingly turning to AI chatbots to find information and news.

Compared with entertaining content on other apps, Nextdoor posts can seem downright boring.

[See **Nextdoor**, A10]



DAVID URBANKE For The Times

IN THE RUNNING

Jeff Hiller is up for a supporting actor Emmy for “Somebody Somewhere.” **ENTERTAINMENT, E3**

Trump accuses Schiff of fraud

President alleges the senator from California is misleading lenders about his primary residence. **NATION, A4**

Weather Clouds, then sun. L.A. Basin: 81/62. **B6**

Markets **A11**
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USC president warns of layoffs

Beong-Soo Kim cites a budget deficit caused by Trump cuts and other factors. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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